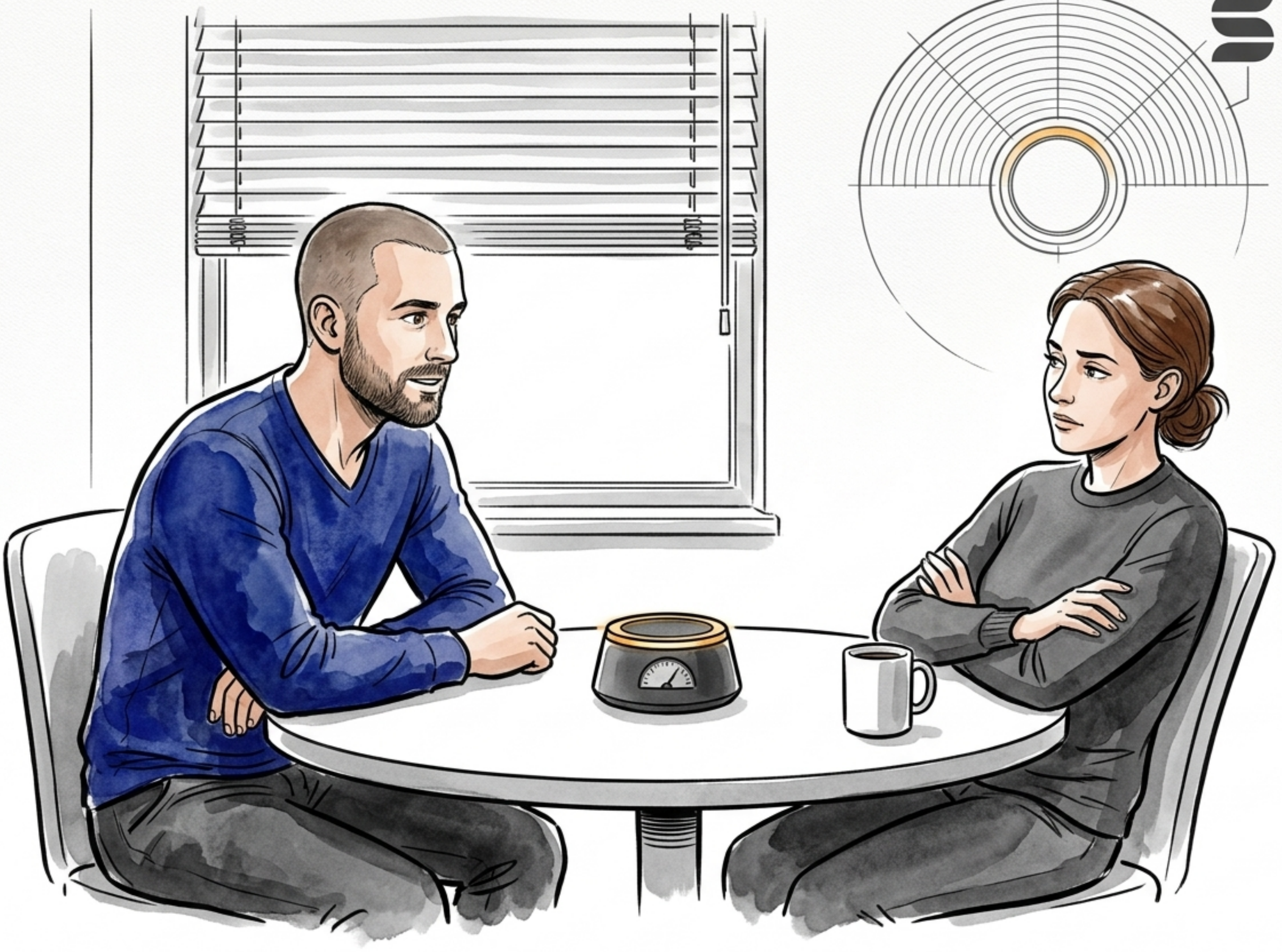


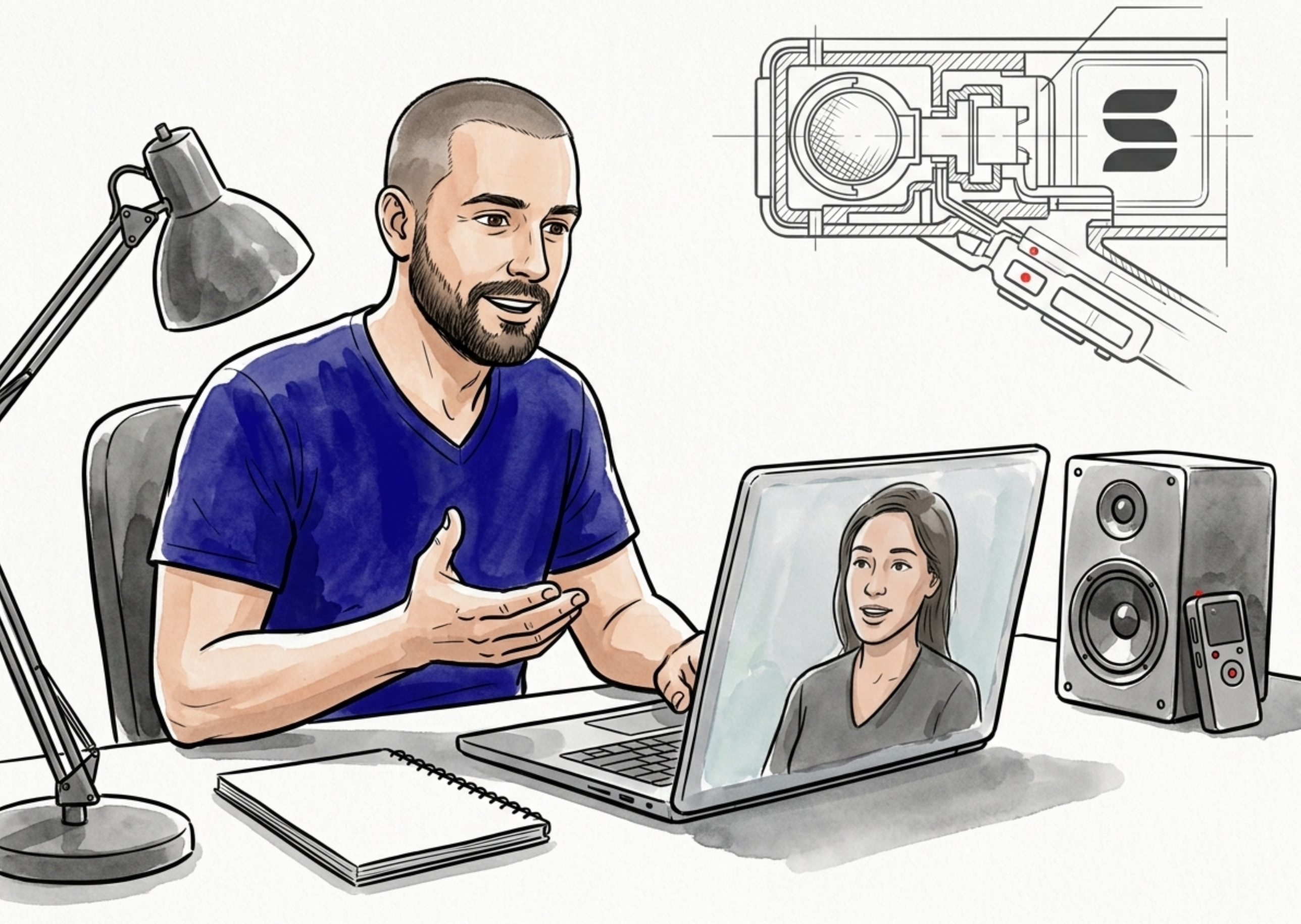
Your 1-on-1s have a second audience now

Some managers already use AI to score how positive their team sounded in 1-on-1s. Not action items. Tone. Nobody asked the direct reports how that felt.



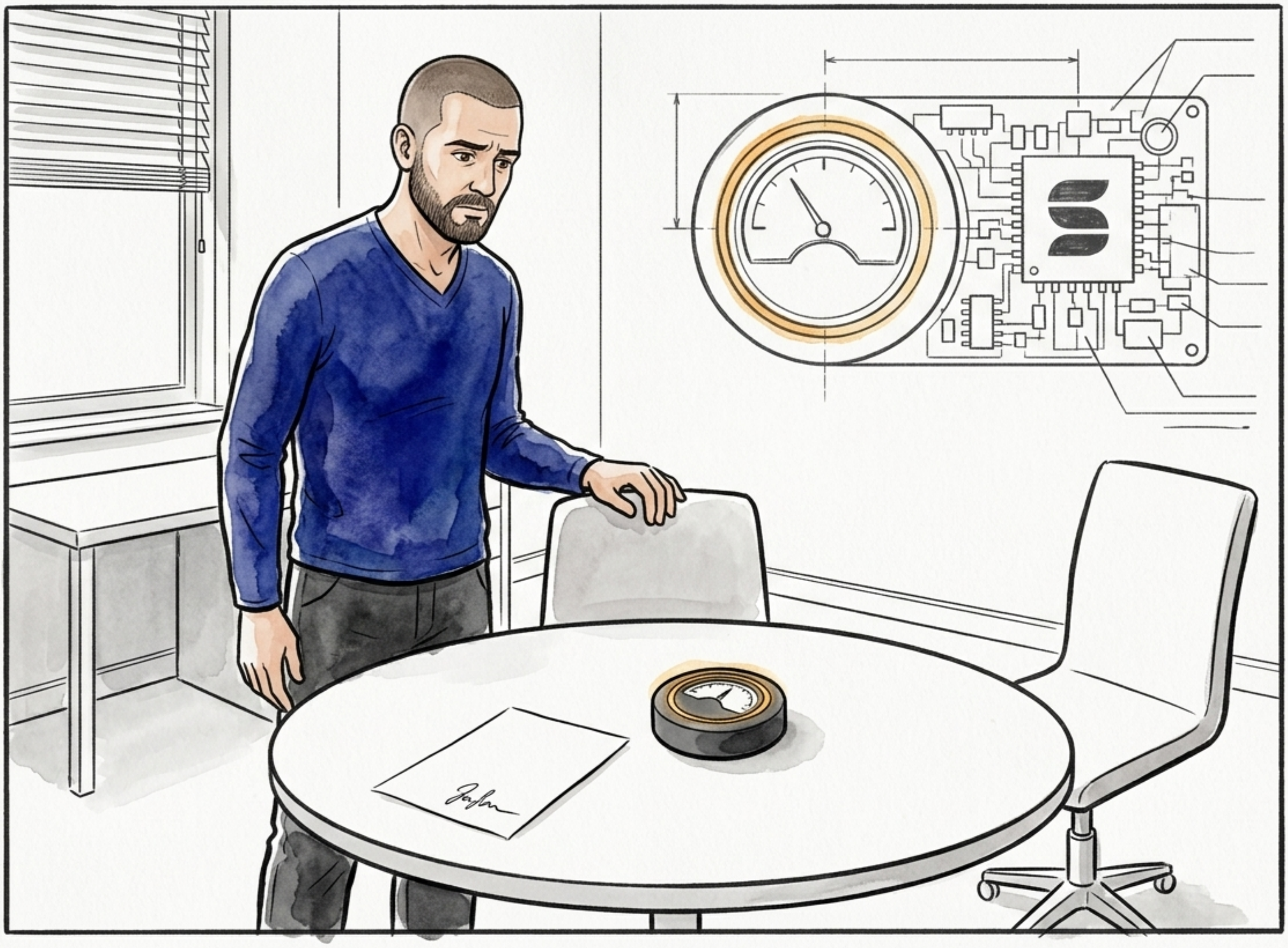
A 1-on-1 is built for the hard thing

It's the one meeting where someone tells you what they'd never say in a group. A transcript makes them wonder who else will read it.



I saw this with my own coaching clients

In training, I recorded client calls. Everyone agreed. Answers still got shorter. I swapped to a small recorder by my speakers. The answers got longer again.



Consent is not the same as honesty

Same agreement, different answers. A signature doesn't make someone forget the second audience. And the transcript can't show you what it's costing you.



Name the second audience out loud

Say who sees the notes, how long they're kept, and what the tool is for. If you can't say why it's in that meeting, it doesn't belong.



Try this on Monday

Pick the 1-on-1 where you most need the honest version. Turn the notetaker off, tell them why, and watch how the length of their answers changes.



A notebook still works for the conversations that matter

If a notetaker sat in on your last 1-on-1, would you have said everything the same way?